

ENG523

1. Discourse Analysis

The study of language use beyond the sentence level, focusing on how meaning is constructed in different contexts and social interactions.

2. Text Grammarians

Experts who analyze written texts to understand relationships between linguistic elements, focusing on how these elements form coherent structures.

3. Functional Linguistics

An approach that examines language based on its social functions, emphasizing how grammar interacts with meaning and context.

4. Halliday's Framework

A model by M.A.K. Halliday that views language as a system of choices influenced by social functions, focusing on thematic and informational structures.

5. Context and Culture in Language

The idea that language use is shaped by its context and cultural influences, affecting how it is interpreted and used.

6. Pragmatics

A branch of linguistics that studies how context influences the interpretation of meaning, including speaker intentions and implied meanings.

7. Speech Acts

Actions performed via language, such as requesting, apologizing, or commanding. Speech acts analyze what the speaker intends to accomplish.

8. Intonation in Discourse

The rise and fall of pitch in speech, which can change the meaning of a statement and reflect emotions or emphasis.

9. Cohesion

The linguistic connections within a text that link sentences together, such as pronouns, conjunctions, or lexical repetition.

10. Coherence

The logical and meaningful connection of ideas in a text, ensuring it "makes sense" to the reader or listener.

11. Turn-Taking

The structured process of managing conversational turns, ensuring participants know when to speak or listen.

12. Adjacency Pairs

Paired utterances in conversation where the first part predicts a specific type of response, like a question-answer or greeting-reply sequence.

13. Initiating Moves

The first action in an interaction, such as asking a question or making a statement, to start a conversational exchange.

14. Eliciting Exchanges

Interactions where one speaker seeks specific information, often seen in classroom settings, such as teacher questions and student responses.

15. Boundary Exchanges

Discourse structures that signal transitions or divisions within conversations, such as shifting topics or concluding segments.

16. Transactional Language

Language used to achieve specific tasks or exchange information, such as ordering food or asking for directions.

17. Interactional Talk

Language used for social purposes, like building relationships or maintaining communication, as in casual conversations.

18. Discourse Markers

Words or phrases, such as *well*, *so*, or *you know*, used to organize speech, manage turn-taking, or signal shifts in topic.

19. Genre vs. Text Type

Genres are culturally recognized categories like novels or essays, while text types (e.g., narrative, descriptive) focus on structural properties of texts.

20. Problem-Solution Pattern

A common discourse structure presenting a situation, identifying a problem, proposing a solution, and evaluating the result.

21. Claim-Counterclaim Pattern

A structure where a claim is stated and challenged by a counterclaim, often used in debates and argumentative texts.

22. General-Specific Pattern

A pattern where a general idea is followed by specific examples or details, commonly found in academic writing.

23. Cultural Rhetoric

The study of how cultural beliefs and values shape rhetorical practices and language use in different societies.

24. Comparative Rhetoric

A cross-cultural analysis of rhetorical traditions, highlighting differences and similarities in communication styles.

25. Schema Theory

A theory stating that readers use their prior knowledge (schemata) to interpret and understand texts.

26. Illocutionary Acts

The intended function of a speech act, such as asserting, questioning, or commanding.

27. Speech Events

Specific communicative situations, like interviews, lectures, or debates, each with its own norms and conventions.

28. Discourse Units

Segments of language that form coherent sections of discourse, such as paragraphs, turns, or entire conversations.

29. Conversational Analysis

A method of studying the structure and patterns of spoken interaction, focusing on turn-taking and conversational norms.

30. Politeness Theory

A framework analyzing how speakers maintain social harmony by managing face (self-image) through politeness strategies.

31. Face-Saving Strategies

Techniques used to avoid threatening someone's self-image in conversation, such as softening criticism.

32. Back-Channeling

Listeners' verbal or non-verbal cues (e.g., *mm-hmm*, nodding) to show attention and encourage the speaker.

33. Transactional Model

A communication model where participants exchange messages simultaneously, influencing each other interactively.

34. Overlapping Talk

When two or more speakers talk at the same time, often signaling enthusiasm or competition for the floor.

35. Topic Management

The skill of maintaining, shifting, or closing topics in conversation.

36. Foregrounded Information

Highlighted or emphasized information in discourse that the speaker wants to focus on.

37. Backgrounded Information

Information given less emphasis or treated as secondary in a discourse.

38. Intercultural Communication

Communication between individuals from different cultural backgrounds, requiring sensitivity to cultural norms and values.

39. Narrative Discourse

The structure and function of storytelling, focusing on how events and characters are presented.

40. Textual Patterns

Recognizable structures within texts, like cause-effect or compare-contrast, aiding comprehension and organization.

41. Explicitness in Written Text

The degree to which a text clearly conveys meaning without relying on shared context or assumptions.

42. Reader-Text Interaction

How readers engage with and interpret a text, influenced by their background knowledge and expectations.

43. Critical Discourse Analysis

A method of examining how power and ideology are reflected and constructed in language use.

44. Metadiscourse

Linguistic elements that organize a text and engage readers, such as transitions, comments, or directives.

45. Information Structuring

Organizing information in discourse to make it coherent and effective for communication.

46. Contextualization Cues

Signals within discourse that help listeners or readers interpret meaning, such as tone, gestures, or keywords.

47. Formal and Content Schemata

Formal schemata refer to knowledge of text structure, while content schemata involve knowledge of the topic.

48. Discourse Competence

The ability to use language effectively in different social and communicative contexts.

49. Lexical Cohesion

Connections within a text created by the use of related words, such as synonyms or repetitions.

50. Ethnographic Methods

Research methods focusing on observing and interpreting language use in real-life contexts.

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Composition